

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent public speaking skills for presenting political arguments and winning support for policies.



The ability to work as part of a team in order to reach a consensus on legislation and policies.



Interpersonal skills for relating to members of the public and understanding their concerns.



Good problem-solving skills for devising political solutions to economic and social problems.



Perseverance and integrity to press for political change and inspire others to adopt the party's cause.



MAYOR Leads a town or city council and presides over local government, taking responsibility for its major departments—including police, fire, housing, education, and transportation.



GOVERNOR Serves as a state's chief executive officer, ensuring all state laws are implemented properly by the state's executive branch. The responsibilities of a governor vary from state to state.



SENATOR Represents his or her state in the senate. This job is part of the legislative branch of government, and it includes writing and voting on bills. State senators serve six-year terms.



PRESIDENT Leads the US government. Serves as Commander in Chief of the federal armed forces, travels extensively to represent the US around the world, and has the power to sign a bill into law.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **CHARITY FUNDRAISER** *see pp. 90–91*
- ▶ **LAWYER** *see pp. 110–111*
- ▶ **POLITICAL SCIENTIST** Uses expertise in areas such as law, politics, and history to research and advise on public policy. Political scientists must stay up to date with political ideas and trends.

In 2014, the United States was ranked 84th in the world for female political leadership.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Politics • Political science • Debating • Current affairs • Law • Economics • Business studies • Sociology • History • Public relations



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Evidence of past political activity is vital. Many politicians hold advanced degrees in law, economics, or political science.



LIFESTYLE Long working hours are common. Debates and campaigning or networking events are often held during evenings. Privacy is difficult.



LOCATION Politicians typically work out of an office in their community, but national—and, sometimes, overseas—travel is required.



THE REALITIES Campaigning during elections can require frequent overnight stays away from home. Politicians' lives are often very public.